

Common Application | Undergraduate

Dakota Moore | CAID: APP_020 | Fall 2026

Applicant information

App ID	APP_020
First Name	Dakota
Last Name	Moore
Date Of Birth	2/14/08
Mailing Address	1019 Test Court, Phoenix, AZ 85004
Primary Phone Number	602-555-0119
Email Address	dakota.moore.020@example.com
Gender	Male
Ethnicity	Black
Country	USA
Region	Southwest

Education and application details

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Name of HS	Phoenix High School
Counselor Name	Riley Bennett
Intended Major	Computer Science
Admission Year	2026
Admission Term	F
Unweighted GPA	3.8
Weighted GPA	3.9
Rank	200/600
Superscored SAT Score	1500
Superscored ACT Score	Not provided

AP Courses

Not provided

Total APs

0

IB Courses

Not provided

Total IBs

Not provided

Activities

Not provided

Awards

Not provided

Hooks

Not provided

Personal essay

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Prompt: Describe an experience that changed how you think or learn.

An error message and a beginning

While teaching myself to code, I once spent far longer reading an error message than writing the program that produced it. I wanted an immediate fix. Eventually I learned to change one thing at a time and explain to myself what I expected the program to do.

My first response was to make the problem smaller than it really was. I wanted a neat explanation and a quick result. When that did not work, I felt embarrassed by how much I had assumed. Looking back, the useful part of the experience began when I admitted that I needed more information. I wrote down what I knew, what I was guessing, and what I still needed to ask. That simple separation helped me move forward without pretending to be certain.

The next attempt was slower. I listened to another perspective, changed one part of my approach, and checked whether the change made sense. I learned that revision is more than replacing a wrong answer with a right one. Sometimes it means changing the question itself. I also learned to explain my choices clearly enough that someone else could challenge them. An idea became more useful when it could survive a conversation rather than only look convincing in my notebook.

That lesson has followed me into ordinary parts of my school life. When I do not understand a reading, I try to identify the sentence where I lost the argument. When a group disagrees, I ask what each person is trying to accomplish. These habits do not solve every problem, and I still sometimes rush toward an answer. But they give me a way to begin again. I am becoming more comfortable saying that I have not figured something out yet, provided that I can describe the next step I will take.

My interest in Computer Science comes partly from this experience. I want to study how ideas meet the complicated conditions of actual lives. I hope college will give me stronger methods, unfamiliar perspectives, and people who will question my assumptions. I do not expect every class to confirm the direction I have chosen. I want some of them to make me reconsider it. Learning should enlarge the questions I can ask as well as the answers I can offer.

The lesson I carry with me is to turn a confusing failure into a question I can test. It sounds modest, but it changes how I work. I now see patience, curiosity, and a willingness to revise as practical responsibilities. I want to contribute to a college community by taking other people seriously, making my reasoning clear, and continuing when a first attempt fails. The moment that matters most to me is no longer the moment I can announce an answer. It is the moment I understand enough to take a more thoughtful next step.

Essay is fictional and generated for this prototype. It is embedded in this CommonApp document.